

COURSE ROADMAP

# From Zero to Shipped

**Build real AI apps fast — and understand every line.**

A grounded vibe-coding curriculum · ~22 weeks · you ship something real every phase

## What is grounded **vibe coding**?

You'll build fast with AI doing much of the typing — **that's the point.**

But you'll also:

- **Read** any file and explain what it does
- **Debug** it when it breaks — and know why
- **Prompt** the AI to produce senior-quality work, not slop

Build fast. Understand deeply. **Ship no slop.**

## The deal

- The AI can build whole chunks at once — **you direct it, and you understand every line before it's accepted.**
- Every session ends with a **walkthrough** and a **quiz**. Miss something? It comes back via spaced repetition.
- You **review every diff** and write every commit message. That's how you stay the author.
- "It works" is never the finish line. "I can explain why it works — and fix it if it breaks" is.

# How every session runs

## THE LOOP

1. **Plan** — you state the goal and draft the prompt
  2. **Build** — pair with the AI in small, understood steps
  3. **Walk through it** — you trace how the code runs, out loud
  4. **Quiz** — short, so it sticks
  5. **Log & commit** — you write the message; your progress is saved
- Plus: weekly AI-free diagnostics · deliberate bug drills · prompt-craft practice

## The journey — 5 phases

Each phase ends with something deployed that a real person actually uses. Pace follows understanding, not the calendar.

# Phase 0 · Foundations & First Deploy

Weeks 1–2

**Goal: a live URL on the internet within 10 days.**

- Your workshop: VS Code + Claude Code
- Terminal, Python, Git, GitHub
- First deploy — frontend vs. backend, reading logs
- First guided bug drill

# Phase 1 · Real App, Real Database

Weeks 3–6

**Goal: a CRUD app a family member uses weekly.**

- Data modeling · SQL by hand
- Python ↔ Postgres · routes & templates
- Forms, validation, HTMX
- JOINS & aggregates · deploy + prod debugging

## Phase 2 · Adding AI

Weeks 7–10

**Goal: genuinely useful AI features you understand.**

- The Messages API · tokens & context
- Prompt engineering · structured outputs
- Streaming · tool use ("chat with your data")
- Your first real API endpoint · cost, latency & safety



## Phase 3 · Public-Ready: API, Users & Security

Weeks 11–16

**Goal: a real app for people beyond family.**

- REST API design · testing with Bruno
- Accounts, login & "Sign in with Google"
- Auth, permissions, CORS, RLS
- Structure, tests, migrations, **concurrency & caching**

# Phase 4 · Understanding What You Built

Weeks 17–18

**Goal: ground your vibe coding all the way down.**

- What really happens on a request
- Python under the hood (async)
- Database internals (indexes, transactions)
- **Solo rebuild challenge** — the graduation exam

## Phase 5 · Monetization & Public Launch

Weeks 19–22+

**Goal: go public with a payment path.**

- Pricing · Stripe · landing page & domain
- Analytics & monitoring
- Launch to real strangers
- The operating loop that never ends

# Your companion dashboard

**RUNS ON YOUR MACHINE**

A little app that keeps the journey **visible and motivating**:

- 🔥 **Streaks** & progress through the phases
- 🧠 **Quizzes** & spaced-repetition review
- 🌐 **Concept map** of what you've learned
- 📖 How-to guides & mockups of your app
- 💬 A built-in **Claude Code client** — browse & continue your sessions

## The graduate

Someone who can **build a real, deployed, AI-powered app fast** —  
and **read it, debug it, secure it, and explain every line.**

An excellent vibe coder who never ships slop.

Ready? Open the Claude panel and say: "**Let's start the curriculum.**"